

Correcting some old-gen myths

In keeping with the theme of this issue related to busting all kinds of technology related myths, it's only apt to recount a few of the biggest myths technology has busted over the last two decades. I won't say these myths arose due to technology, but think of them as largely universal perceptions that technology helped question and correct over time. Take gaming, for example.

Not too long ago, gaming wasn't only considered a waste of time but it was ridiculed and picked upon by peers. Growing up, I enjoyed playing video games with a couple of my best friends, especially whenever I went to visit my grandparents. We weren't just gaming nonstop cooped up inside our homes, participating in outdoor sports and activities as well – but that didn't stop the rest of our friends from picking on us for “wasting” our time playing “meaningless” video games. This was obviously nothing in comparison to the draconian attitudes of elder family members towards gaming altogether – be it video games or sports – who obviously thought these were distractions in the road of academic glory. The thought that you can make a career out of gaming wouldn't even have crossed their minds!

Fast forward to the 2020s, and not only is gaming the biggest category of the global entertainment industry, it's also providing millions of people with creative jobs. And within gaming, the section consisting of esports players and gaming content creators is only growing, according to several reports.

Surely this can't just be a passing fad? Slowly but surely, technological advancements, be it better hardware or access to the internet has helped to unlock gaming's true potential. It's helping correct the myth of any form of gaming to be a waste of time, and about time.

Another older myth related to work was challenged during and after the recent pandemic, especially the how and where of work – and not just in the eyes of older generations. The idea that you commute to and from an office building, a place where work was traditionally done on weekdays, was turned



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on its head in most parts of the world in 2020. In a lockdown environment, technology forced employees and businesses to transact work remotely as much as possible.

Working from the office switched to working from home, not just in the IT and technology sector but every business and industry that survived the pandemic. Even here at Digit, all of us did what we had to do to get the job done during those days – from home, office or some other remote location. It couldn't have happened if technology hadn't come to our aid. The rise of work from home has well and truly busted the age-old myth that work can only be done in an office, and long may it continue.

The final old-gen myth that technology's busting is related to education in general, a journey that I'm personally living. I won't be too brash to claim that schools have no place in a person's educational arc, having been blessed with excellent teachers in my formative years. But I certainly feel that just like an office or workplace the brick-and-mortar concept of school is fast becoming extinct.

From YouTube to online MOOCs, the internet allows you access to a vast ocean of tutored knowledge from outside the traditional classrooms. From my daughter learning something new on TED-Ed to my attempts to unravel the mysteries of the stock market, you don't need to wait to go to a school to enlighten yourself. Entire semester courses from the likes of Harvard and other prestigious universities are now available online, completely free of cost!

Tech companies now increasingly look for what skills prospective hires may have, apart from overly relying on just their education qualifications. I'm not downplaying the importance of formal education we all receive in our respective schools and colleges, simply acknowledging how we are educating ourselves differently now than 20 years ago.

If you have access to the internet in 2023 and beyond, there's no excuse to not continually upskill yourself. All thanks to technology, of course. **d**